



However, in the physically demanding world of kabaddi, a sharp mind alone isn't always enough to secure a place on the mat.

Auctions are a useful tool for price corrections, especially for teams fielding more expensive players. For instance, the Telugu Titans successfully reduced its expenditure on Pawan Sehrawat from ₹2.61 crore last season to ₹1.725 crore this year, while Shadloui's price saw only a marginal drop from ₹2.35 crore to ₹2.07 crore. Haryana Steelers' Pardeep Narwal, another PKL icon and one of its most expensive players at one point, only drew a top bid of ₹77 lakh from Bengaluru Bulls — far below his previous lofty standards and popularity.

With a purse of ₹5 crore, teams were largely conservative in their spending. Outfits like Puneri Paltan, Haryana Steelers, and Jaipur Pink Panthers, which have built a young core over the years, focused on

making strategic additions to enhance their squads. Meanwhile, teams like Tamil Thalaivas, Telugu Titans, Bengaluru Bulls, and Bengal Warriors sought to build new cores for the upcoming season.

Young Indian raiders from the domestic circuit were the primary targets for most franchises. Their lower base prices helped, but it also highlighted the increased scrutiny of district tournaments and senior national championships.

Randhir Sehrawat, the only head coach to remain with the same

franchise from the start (Bengaluru Bulls), is a strong advocate of such talent scouting. A regular at regional tournaments, he has discovered and nurtured talents like Pawan, Pardeep, and Bharat Hooda (who replaced Pardeep in the UP Yoddhas lineup this season) within the PKL and National set-up.

Global footprint shrinks again

On the international front, Iran once again dominated the player pool, with 17 of the 21 chosen players hailing from the country.



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